Questionnaire: Coles – supermarket site in Rainbow Beach, NSW

MN-25062

Deadline to respond: 17 November 2026

The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (**ACCC**) is currently assessing the proposed acquisition by Coles Supermarkets Australia Pty Ltd, a subsidiary of Coles Group Limited (**Coles**), of a leasehold interest for a new supermarket site located at Lot 238, Ocean Drive, Lake Cathie NSW 2445 in the Rainbow Beach Estate (the **Target Site**) from St Vincents Foundation Pty Ltd (the **Lessor**) (the **Acquisition**).

Coles is an Australian public company (ASX:COL) that primarily operates:

- supermarkets nationwide through its subsidiary, Coles Supermarkets Australia Pty Ltd (**CSA**)
- retail liquor stores nationwide, trading under the Liquorland, Liquorland Warehouse and Liquorland Cellars brands.
- a property development arm, Coles Group Property Developments Ltd, that buys land and constructs shopping centres, standalone supermarkets and/or liquor outlets and then sells these completed sites to third party buyers.

The Lessor is a registered Australian charity associated with the Roman Catholic Church Lismore Diocese.

CSA has signed a letter of offer with the Lessor, and the proposed Coles supermarket is anticipated to open at the Target Site around July 2029.

For further information about the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition, see the ACCC's Acquisitions Register.

The ACCC is assessing the impact of the Acquisition on competition and is seeking your views. The ACCC invites you to provide submissions or information in response to the questions below by **17 November 2026** via email to mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Submission re: Coles – supermarket site in Rainbow Beach, NSW.* The ACCC must complete its assessment within strict statutory timelines which also impacts the time available for consultation.

If you would prefer to speak to a member of the ACCC case team, please email mergers@accc.gov.au with the title *Request for call re: Coles – supermarket site in Rainbow Beach, NSW*. Someone from the case team will contact you to find a suitable time for a call.

Please note that:

- This request is made in accordance with section 51ABZZD(2)(a) and (c) of the *Competition and Consumer Act 2010* (Cth) (the **Act**). This means that

while the ACCC may take into account submissions or information received after the due date, it is not required to do so.

- In responding to the questions below or when providing a submission, please highlight and/or mark any confidential information and indicate why the information is confidential (as brief reasons in footnotes in your response or submission, or in a separate document such as the ACCC's general confidentiality claims template). The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are outlined at the end of this document.

Questions

1. Outline any concerns regarding the impact of the Acquisition on competition.

2. Provide any additional information or comments that you consider relevant to the ACCC's assessment of the Acquisition.

3. Provide a brief description of your business or organisation, including any commercial relationships with Coles and/or the Lessor.

Confidentiality of responses

During the ACCC's assessment of a notified acquisition, the ACCC may receive information that is properly regarded as being confidential, and which is provided to the ACCC in confidence. The ACCC is committed to treating this information responsibly and in accordance with the law. The ACCC understands the importance of confidentiality to parties involved in a notified acquisition, as well as to third parties that provide information to the ACCC.

The standard terms on which the ACCC accepts confidential information are:

- there is no restriction on the internal use, including future use, that the ACCC may make of the confidential information consistent with the ACCC's statutory functions
- confidential information may be disclosed to the ACCC's external advisors and consultants on condition that each such advisor or consultant will be informed of the obligation to treat the information as confidential, and
- the ACCC may disclose the confidential information to other third parties if compelled by law or in accordance with section 155AAA of the Act. This includes disclosures made in the performance of official duties or functions, which include transparency requirements which are part of the merger control regime.

For further information on confidentiality, see the ACCC's confidentiality quick guide**.**